

Module 3 — Making Your First Map Data

Handout · geojson.io · HIST 1907

Handout: How to make your GeoJSON in geojson.io

This week you'll turn your place — and a few places it was connected to — into a data file a map can read. Nothing to install, no code. If a “Sign up for Mapbox” prompt appears, ignore it; you don't need an account.

Steps

1. Go to geojson.io in your browser.
2. Find your place: use the Search box (top-right of the map), or zoom and pan to it.
3. Click the point tool (the dot icon in the top-left toolbar), then click the map where your place is. A point appears and a Feature Editor opens at the bottom.
4. Add three fields to the point. In the “New key / New value” row, type the field name on the left and the information on the right, then click the + button:
 - Name — what the place is called (e.g., Genbaku Dome)
 - Date — when it existed; plain text is fine (e.g., 1945, or “late 19th century”)
 - Description — one or two sentences of history
5. Repeat for at least four more places, so you have five or more total — your place plus the places it was connected to.
6. Watch the panel on the right fill in as you go. That's your GeoJSON being written — you never type there yourself.
7. Export the file: top-right, Export → GeoJSON. It downloads to your computer.
8. Rename it simply, with no spaces (e.g., `hiroshima.geojson`), and upload it to Canvas.

Tips

- Spell the fields exactly: Name, Date, Description, with capital first letters.
- The year goes in Date, not Name. Name is what the place is called.
- geojson.io may auto-add a field called “label” — ignore or delete it. What matters is your three fields.
- Exporting is how you save. If you close the tab without exporting, your work is gone.
- Can't find a historic place on the modern map? Look it up on the World Historical Gazetteer (whgazetteer.org) and use its coordinates.

If something goes wrong

- Point in the wrong spot? Use the arrow tool to drag it, or delete it and place a new one.
- A popup looks empty later? That point is missing one of the three fields — add it.
- Prefer a spreadsheet view? Click the Table tab (top-right) and type your values in columns.